

Q16

The resistance should start at zero ($s = 0$), increase in magnitude and then end at zero ($s = L$).

Let resistance per unit length of the wire be k .

The resistance between X and Y will be that of two resistors in parallel.

$$\text{Thus } R = \left(\frac{1}{R_1} + \frac{1}{R_2} \right)^{-1} = \frac{R_1 R_2}{R_1 + R_2}$$

$$\text{or } R = \frac{(ks)[k(L-s)]}{ks + k(L-s)} = \frac{ks(L-s)}{L}$$

The variation of R with s is therefore not a straight-line relationship.

Ans: B

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